



EventCentral

EventCentral

Find your people. Find your place.

Business Plan

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Problem Summary

There exists no specific channel for students to discover events happening in and around campus, nor for clubs, student organizations, and local businesses to promote their events. This results in events going unknown and unattended by students, resulting in a loss of community, time, and money.

Solution Summary

EventCentral promotes campus event awareness and attendance by providing a centralized digital platform for students to find events and for organizations to advertise events, with data protection and security ensured.

Market

Our target customer base is located at the University of Massachusetts Amherst (UMass) and our market segments are students, as well as clubs, organizations, and local businesses.

Competition

Our main competition is CampusPulse, another event platform at UMass Amherst, and Instagram, a social media platform. Customers consider CampusPulse because it is promoted by UMass and consider Instagram because it is already widely used.

Why Us?

Carol Ding — Chief Financial Officer

Nivaan Gupta — Chief Technology Officer

Gianna Leidich — Chief Operations Officer

Aarushi Pradhan — Chief Marketing Officer

Our team met through CS 420 at UMass where we all go to school. We are all computer science majors with experience working in the technology industry as interns and as executive board members of campus organizations.

Our experience as UMass students allows us to uniquely understand our user base and the problem we are trying to solve, which fuels our passion for creating a platform that makes it easier for students to find interesting events and make new friends.

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Expectations Forecast

Our academic events platform projects revenue growth from \$133,000 in Year 1 to \$310,000 by Year 5, driven by a tiered subscription model, expanding user adoption, and market expansion to additional schools. With strong 80%+ renewal rates and widening profit margins, we demonstrate a sustainable and scalable business model.

OPPORTUNITY

Problem & Solution

Problem Worth Solving

It is difficult for students to find events on campus and it is equally as difficult for campus clubs, student organizations, and small businesses to promote their events. This creates a disconnect: students miss out on attending fun events and meeting other students and organizations lose time and money hosting events with minimal attendance.

Our Solution

EventCentral is a digital application that acts as a centralized platform, connecting both our customer bases: students and organizers. EventCentral helps students find new and interesting events, with features such as sort by category and purchase tickets in-app. It also helps organizers promote their events by allowing them to create event posts, which contain event descriptions, locations, and ticket sales.

Our customers will buy EventCentral, because it will streamline finding and sharing events, turning a convoluted process into an easy, application-based activity.

EventCentral is special, because it offers more features than our main competitor, CampusPulse. For example, it provides organizers with in-depth analytics about attendance and sales and allows students to buy tickets in-app, streamlining and ameliorating the purchase process.

Furthermore, EventCentral employs data protection and user security features, which allows students to feel comfortable on the platform, knowing that their data will not be sold or used for unrelated purposes. So, students can focus on attending fun events and building community, without worrying about whether their data and information will be unfairly distributed.

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Target Market

Market Size & Segments

Group 1 → UMass students. The students are the ones who will be buying tickets to events on EventCentral. They are the ones who want to find events they want to go to, and meet new people at these events. According to [US news](#), there are about 24,000 undergraduate students and 32,000 total students at UMass Amherst. For this group, there is a \$1/month basic tier and a \$5/month premium tier subscription.

Based on the results from our market survey, we assume that 70% of student users are on the basic plan and 30% are on the premium plan. School is in session for 8 months out of the year. From this information, we calculate the average student revenue is \$17.6 per year.

Group 2 → Student organizations and local businesses. These are the groups that will be posting events on EventCentral. They want to get more people to know about their event and get more attendees. According to [Campus Pulse](#), there are 600 organizations on campus, and according to [Amherst downtown directory](#), there are 170 businesses in downtown Amherst. In total, there are 770 potential customers for this group. For this group, there is a \$15 monthly subscription plan. School is in session for 8 months out of the year. For this information, we calculate the average organization revenue is \$120 per year.

Adding together the market size for each group, we get 32,770 potential users. There are 32,000 students so the total potential revenue for students is $32,000 * 17.6 = \$563,200$. There are 770 organizations so the total potential revenue for this group is $770 * 120 = 92,400$. Adding these together, we got the TAM is $563,200 + 92,400 = \$655,600$.

Competition

Current Alternatives

Our main competition is CampusPulse, another event platform at UMass. This is the default event platform at UMass, as it is partnered with UMass and pushed at summer orientation and transfer student events.

Another form of competition is Instagram, a social media platform. Many organizations have Instagram accounts and promote their events there.

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Our Advantages

EventCentral offers more features than CampusPulse, such as in-depth analytics for organizations on the platform. This helps organizations gauge interest and participation, allowing them to adjust future events and plans.

Additionally, though CampusPulse is the default, it is not very modern, not widely used, and more importantly, not developed with real user feedback from the target audience. In contrast, we are incorporating real user feedback into EventCentral, to create a platform that will use and *want* to use.

Our other competition is Instagram, but unlike us, Instagram is not focused on event finding and promoting. Our features help organizers create event posts, instead of just Instagram posts that are centered around events. Therefore, EventCentral slots into a niche that Instagram does not quite fill.

EXECUTION

Marketing & Sales

Marketing Plan

We plan on employing several marketing strategies, including advertising on social media (Instagram), posting flyers in the Student Union, and creating newsletters.

We want to post on Instagram, because a lot of students and organizations find and promote events on there now, so a lot of our target audience is already there. If we post about EventCentral there, we are more likely to attract potential users that are already in the event scene.

Similarly, a lot of campus events take place at the Student Union. Therefore, we would like to create flyers about our application there, since a lot of our target audience hosts events there already.

Finally, as for newsletter, we would like to create these to really get in touch and build connections with our user base. Our newsletters will include updates on platform development and features.

Operations

Public Interest Technology

We are focusing on data protection, privacy, and accessibility. For data protection and privacy, we would like to use user data to recommend events users would be interested in, based on their history and information. However, we want to make it absolutely clear that user data will not be distributed or sold in any way. This will allow our users an elevated user experience, without worrying about their data being sold by us.

For accessibility, we will follow WCAG guidelines on accessibility. For example, in our MVP, we use the WAVE checker to check for color contrast and compliance with other digital accessibility guidelines. This will allow our application to be usable and accessible to all users.

Other Technology Details

We plan on using GitHub and AWS to develop our platform. We will use React as our main framework. We also plan on using AI platforms, specifically Claude Code, to help streamline the development of our application.

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We also plan on using Asana for project and task management, to help keep ourselves on track and accountable. Additionally, we will purchase an Adobe license for marketing design and use the free version of Figma for UI/UX design.

Equipment & Tools

We plan on purchasing Macs and Mac minis that the founders and employees can use, as well as a printer to print our flyers.

COMPANY

Overview

The four of us: Carol, Gianna, Aarushi, and Nivaan own this company. We each own 25% of this company as we founded it together and contributed an equal amount. We are a limited liability corporation (LLC) because we do not have a lot of business experience and want to protect ourselves and our assets.

Team

Management Team

Carol Ding is the Chief Financial Officer. She is in charge of budgeting, pricing, and ensuring that the business is financially sound. She keeps track of revenue and expenses. She is a mathematics major so she has a strong background in mathematics and statistics.

Gianna Leidich is the Chief Operations Officer. She makes sure that everything runs smoothly. She ensures that there is smooth and clear coordination between different parts of the team. She has internship experience in coordinating operations for the UMass Center for Data Science & AI.

Aarushi Pradhan is the Chief Marketing Officer. She works to get EventCentral's name out there by targeting outreach to UMass students and organizations. She has club experience where she works as part of the marketing team to promote her club.

Nivaan Gupta is the Chief Technology Officer. He is in charge of building the product, and ensuring it runs smoothly. He has internship experience as a software engineering intern at multiple companies.

Advisors

Our advisor is Shaheel Dolakia. He is the director of product management at Relay Network. He will be able to help us throughout the deployment process of our product. His professional industry experience will be able to help us make informed decisions as we launch our product and as we continue to improve it.

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FINANCIAL PLAN

Business Model

We are a for-profit organization, and our business model is a bottom-up model using a tiered subscription, with a basic tier for students of \$1/month, a premium tier for students of \$5/month, and a premium tier for organizations of \$15/month. According to [Yahoo Finance](#), the average American has about 5 monthly subscriptions and pays about \$70, and to ensure that EventCentral is affordable and does not add too much to that load, we only charge students \$1/month for basic and \$5/month for premium.

These subscription tiers are our main source of revenue. We have a TAM of \$665.6k (see above), and our aim is to cover around 20% of this market in the first year, so our revenue goal for the first year is around \$133k.

Forecast

Key Assumptions

Since EventCentral is a new venture with no past sales data, revenue projections are built entirely from bottom-up market research and a user survey. Our TAM of \$665.6k comes from UMass's 32,000 students, 770 campus organizations, and downtown businesses, according to [US news](#).

We project capturing 20% of TAM (\$133k) in Year 1, growing to 35% by Year 3, driven by increased adoption and expansion to additional schools. Specifically, we are looking at the Four Colleges, where population for:

- [Smith College](#) is 2.5k students
- [Mount Holyoke College](#) is 2.3k students
- [Amherst College](#) is 1.9k students

Student revenue uses our survey-based assumption that 70% choose the \$1/month basic tier and 30% choose the \$5/month premium tier, yielding a blended \$17.60/student/year across 8 school months. Organizations pay \$15/month (\$120/year).

Key expenses include \$10k in one-time startup costs (AWS, hardware, software licenses) and \$100k in personnel, which includes a full-time UI/UX developer (\$58k according to [Zip Recruiter](#)), a part-time marketing intern (\$21/hr also according to [Zip Recruiter](#)), and an hourly legal consultant (\$370/hr according to [Contracts Counsel](#)). Founders take no salary in Year 1. We expect a Year 1 net profit of \$23k, growing steadily as revenue scales faster than expenses.

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Revenue by Month



Figure 1: Revenue by Month for Year 1: A graph depicting our revenue for Year 1. We launch in September where we predict \$5k, then steadily increase with slight dips for winter break. Then, we peak in May, before dipping during the summer.

Revenue launches at \$5K in September and builds steadily through the academic year, peaking at \$18K in May as the user base grows through word-of-mouth and marketing. Summer months (June - August) dip due to fewer students on campus; however, we provide a baseline of continued subscription income.

Expenses by Month

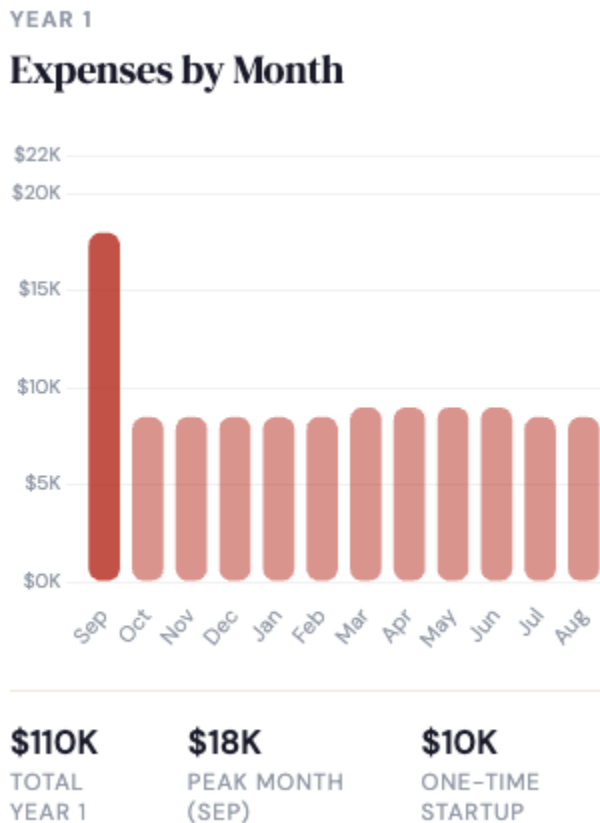


Figure 2: Expenses by Month for Year 1: A graph depicting our revenue for Year 1. We spike in September due to one-time start-up costs. In the following months, costs stabilize.

September spikes to \$18K due to one-time startup costs, including hardware (Macs, Mac minis, and a printer), licenses (Adobe), and software (AWS), along with regular personnel expenses. After that, monthly costs stabilize at roughly \$8,500–\$9,000, covering the UI/UX developer salary, marketing intern hours, and occasional legal consultant fees for the remainder of the year.

Net Profit (or Loss) by Year



Figure 3: Net Profit (or Loss) by Year for 5-Year Outlook: A graph depicting our revenue and expenses and net profit as a result. Our revenue is greater than our expenses, even in Year 1, leading to an overall profit.

Revenue grows faster than expenses because hiring scales slowly while subscriptions compound. Year 1 profit is modest at \$23K as startup costs are absorbed, but the gap between revenue and expenses widens each year. By Year 5, feature expansion and school-to-school growth push profit to \$103K, demonstrating strong long-term margin improvement.

Financing

Use of Funds

We plan to use our funds for the startup costs of \$10k for licenses and tech, like an AWS account, Asana, a Claude max subscription, Mac and Mac mini computers. We also have variable costs of around \$100k for the salaries of a legal consultant, who we pay for by the hour, a full-time UI/UX engineer, and a part-time marketing intern.

Figure 4: Startup costs: A table showing where our startup costs, which come to \$10k total, go to, including software licenses and hardware machines.

Category	Item	Cost
Software licenses	AWS Account	\$500
Hardware	Mac Computer	\$3000
Hardware	Mac Mini (2x)	\$2400
Hardware	Printer	\$400
SUBTOTAL		\$6300

Figure 5: Fixed costs: A table showing where our fixed costs, which are mostly subscriptions and salaries. The subtotal is what we pay monthly.

Category	Item	Cost
Software licenses	AWS Account	\$500
Software licenses	Asana	\$180
Software licenses	Claude Max Subscription	\$240
Software licenses	Adobe Creative Cloud	\$720
Salary	UI/UX Designer	\$4800
SUBTOTAL (monthly)		\$6440

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Figure 6: Variable costs: A table showing our variable costs, including our AWS account (scales with usage) and legal consult (pay by the hour).

Item	Cost
AWS Account	\$500–1000 (scales with usage)
Legal consultant	\$370/hour
Marketing Intern	\$21/hour
SUBTOTAL	~\$1500

Sources of Funds

We are investing our own money with backing from our families, at least for the early stages of our venture. Since our costs are about \$100k for salaries and 10k for startup costs (licenses, tech, etc.), our plan is to get around \$28k (\$7k each) from our families and not pay ourselves anything for the first year and put whatever money we make back into the business. This is subject to change, and we will know more about this after initial feedback on launching.

Figure 7: Funding commitment from each founder: A table showing the breakdown of funding commitments from each founder.

Name	Funding commitment
Gianna Leidich	\$7000
Carol Ding	\$7000
Aarushi Pradhan	\$7000
Nivaan Gupta	\$7000
TOTAL	\$28000

Milestones & Metrics

Milestones

Figure 8: Milestones by month: Starting from our initial launch in September, we record milestones that let us know that EventCentral is following its projected growth. Milestones include development goals, launch, and user activity goals.

Month	Milestone
August 2026	Finish building our MVP with all core features like event discovery, event posting, in-app ticket purchasing, and student and organizer profiles. This is our target to be ready before the school year starts.
September 2026	Officially launch EventCentral at UMass Amherst at the start of the fall semester, when student activity is at its highest, and the most people are looking for things to do.
October 2026	Get registered users to engage and actually use EventCentral, through marketing campaigns and word-of-mouth advertising.
November 2026	Check that users are actually coming back and engaging with the app, not just signing up and forgetting about it.
February 2027	Launch our academic events feature to expand into more markets and reach new customers (specifically, those in academia).
June 2027	Roll out orientation event features to support incoming freshman and transfer students over the summer.
August 2027	Begin expanding EventCentral to the Five Colleges and other UMass campuses, using everything we learned from Year 1 to do it right.
September 2027 (year after launch)	End of Year 1: Hit \$133K in revenue, \$23K in profit, and set ourselves up to grow toward 35% TAM capture in Year 2.

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Key Metrics

The most important thing for us to track is whether students and organizations are actually using EventCentral, not just signing up for it.

Figure 9: Key metrics summary: A table showing our key metrics, for growth, engagement, and revenue. Our goal is to monitor both growth and usage, which are the driving factors behind revenue.

Metric	Description
Growth	We want to see 10,000+ users at launch and 25,000+ for strong traction, along with a healthy number of active organization accounts posting events
Engagement	We track daily active users and how often users returns after signing up. If someone creates an account but never opens the app again, that is a problem that we need to catch early and fix.
Revenue	We monitor monthly recurring revenue and our subscription renewal rate, aiming for 80%+ retention between semesters. A key checkpoint is hitting ~\$5,500 in monthly revenue by February, which keeps us on pace for our \$133K Year 1 goal.

Simply put, success means students are finding events, organizations are posting them, and people keep coming back.

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Statements

Projected Profit & Loss (5 years)

Figure 10: 5-year profit projection: A table showing our 5-year profit projections. Revenue steadily increases as we increase our TAM through new features, and because expenses scale more slowly, we see an overall increase in profit.

Year	Revenue	Expenses	Profit
Year 1	\$133,000	\$110,000	\$23,000
Year 2	\$185,000	\$140,000	\$45,000
Year 3	\$233,000	\$163,000	\$70,000
Year 4	\$278,000	\$180,000	\$98,000
Year 5	\$310,000	\$207,000	\$103,000

We project steady financial growth over its first five years, driven by a tiered subscription model targeting UMass Amherst students and campus organizations. In Year 1, we forecast \$133,000 in revenue by capturing 20% of our \$665,600 TAM, resulting in a net profit of approximately \$23,000 after \$110,000 in total expenses.

Expenses include \$10,000 in one-time startup costs covering hardware, AWS, and software licenses, plus \$100,000 in personnel costs for a full-time UI/UX developer, part-time marketing intern, and hourly legal consultant.

Revenue grows to \$185,000 in Year 2 and \$233,000 by Year 3 as TAM capture increases to 35%, driven by higher user adoption and feature expansion to additional schools. Expenses scale more slowly, widening the profit margin each year. By Year 5, we project \$310,000 in revenue and \$103,000 in net profit, demonstrating a sustainable and scalable business model.

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Projected Balance Sheet (5 years)

Figure 11: 5-year balance sheet: A table showing our balance sheet projections for the next 5 years. The projected balance sheet shows where we stand financially over five years and how our assets, liabilities, and equity grow as the business gets off the ground.

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
ASSETS					
Cash & Equivalents	\$25,000	\$58,000	\$112,000	\$182,000	\$268,000
Accounts Receivable	\$2,000	\$3,500	\$5,000	\$6,500	\$8,000
Equipment (net of depreciation)	\$8,000	\$6,000	\$4,500	\$3,000	\$1,500
Total Assets	\$35,000	\$67,500	\$121,500	\$191,500	\$277,500
LIABILITIES					
Accounts Payable	\$2,000	\$2,500	\$2,500	\$2,500	\$2,500
Accrued Expenses	\$2,000	\$2,500	\$3,000	\$3,500	\$3,500
Total Liabilities	\$4,000	\$5,000	\$5,500	\$6,000	\$6,000
OWNERS' EQUITY					
Founders' Capital (\$28K × 4)	\$112,000	\$112,000	\$112,000	\$112,000	\$112,000
Retained Earnings	(\$81,000)	(\$49,500)	\$4,000	\$73,500	\$159,500
Total Equity	\$31,000	\$62,500	\$116,000	\$185,500	\$271,500
Total Liabilities + Equity	\$35,000	\$67,500	\$121,500	\$191,500	\$277,500

In Year 1, our total assets are \$35,000, made up of \$25,000 in cash, \$2,000 in accounts receivable from pending subscription payments, and \$8,000 in equipment net of depreciation, covering the Macs and Mac minis we purchased at launch. Our liabilities are intentionally kept low at \$4,000, consisting of accounts payable and accrued expenses, and we have no loans or external debt. Our equity is backed entirely by the \$112,000 in founder capital that all four of us contributed equally.

Retained earnings appear negative in Year 1 at (\$81,000) because the founder investment was deployed to cover startup and operating costs rather than held as cash surplus. This is completely expected for a new venture and does not indicate any financial distress. By Year 3, retained earnings turn positive at \$4,000 as cumulative profits start to outpace the initial investment drawdown.

From Year 3 onward, our balance sheet strengthens significantly. Cash grows from \$112,000 in Year 3 to \$268,000 by Year 5, driven by increasing subscription revenue and stable, controlled expenses. Equipment depreciates steadily and is not replaced, since we are a software-based platform that requires minimal physical infrastructure beyond our initial purchase.

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Total assets reach \$277,500 by Year 5, while liabilities stay low and flat at \$6,000. Overall, our balance sheet reflects a lean, financially responsible startup that is building real equity value without taking on any debt, growing steadily on founder capital alone.

Projected Cash Flow Statement (5 years)

Figure 12: 5-year cash flow statement: A table showing our projected cash flow for the next 5 years. The projected cash flow statement tracks the actual movement of cash in and out of our business across five years, giving a clear picture of our liquidity and long-term financial sustainability. It is broken into three sections: operating, investing, and financing activities.

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
OPERATING ACTIVITIES					
Net Income	\$23,000	\$45,000	\$69,000	\$87,000	\$103,000
Add: Depreciation	\$2,000	\$2,000	\$1,500	\$1,500	\$1,500
Change in Accounts Receivable	(\$2,000)	(\$1,500)	(\$1,500)	(\$1,500)	(\$1,500)
Change in Accounts Payable	\$2,000	\$500	\$0	\$500	\$0
Change in Accrued Expenses	\$2,000	\$500	\$500	\$500	\$0
Net Cash from Operations	\$27,000	\$46,500	\$69,500	\$88,000	\$103,000
INVESTING ACTIVITIES					
Equipment Purchases	(\$10,000)	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Net Cash from Investing	(\$10,000)	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
FINANCING ACTIVITIES					
Founders' Capital Contributions	\$112,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Net Cash from Financing	\$112,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Net Change in Cash	\$129,000	\$46,500	\$69,500	\$88,000	\$103,000
Beginning Cash Balance	\$0	\$25,000	\$58,000	\$112,000	\$182,000
Ending Cash Balance	\$25,000	\$58,000	\$112,000	\$182,000	\$268,000

In Year 1, our operating activities generate \$27,000 in net cash. We start with our \$23,000 net income and add back \$2,000 in depreciation, since depreciation is a non-cash expense that does not actually leave our bank account. We also account for small changes in accounts receivable, payable, and accrued expenses, which capture the timing differences between when revenue is earned and when cash is actually collected, and when expenses are incurred versus paid. These working capital adjustments are small but matter for accurately representing where our cash actually sits.

Our investing activities show a one-time outflow of (\$10,000) in Year 1, covering the hardware we purchased at launch including Macs and Mac minis for the founding team. After that, we

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have no further investing outflows across the five-year period, which reflects our asset-light, software-focused approach to building the business.

Financing activities capture the \$112,000 founder capital contribution in Year 1, which is the backbone of how we fund the business in its early stages. No additional financing is needed after that, as we become operationally self-sustaining from Year 2 onward.

Our ending cash balance grows consistently from \$25,000 at the end of Year 1 to \$268,000 by Year 5. This steady buildup of cash shows that we become increasingly self-sufficient over time, generating enough subscription revenue to cover all expenses and build a healthy cash reserve without ever needing to rely on outside loans or investor funding.